INCH-POUND
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PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION

INSULATION BLANKET, THERMAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers metal-wire mesh reinforced thermal insulation blankets intended for insulation of hot surfaces at temperatures up to 1,200 °F (650 °C).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-1623 - Fire Performance Requirements and Approved Specifications for Interior Finish Materials and Furnishings (Naval Shipboard Use)

(Copies of this document are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil/.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

NAVAL SEA SYSTEMS COMMAND (NAVSEA) PUBLICATIONS

S9510-AB-ATM-010 - Nuclear Powered Submarine Atmosphere Control Manual

(Copies of the chapter titled “Material Control Program” are available by email request to CommandStandards@navy.mil.)

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil, with the subject line “Document Comment”. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM C167 - Standard Test Methods for Thickness and Density of Blanket or Batt Thermal Insulations

ASTM C177 - Standard Test Method for Steady-State Heat Flux Measurements and Thermal Transmission Properties by Means of the Guarded-Hot-Plate Apparatus

ASTM C411 - Standard Test Method for Hot-Surface Performance of High-Temperature Thermal Insulation

ASTM C447 - Standard Practice for Estimating the Maximum Use Temperature of Thermal Insulations

ASTM C592 - Standard Specification for Mineral Fiber Blanket Insulation and Blanket-Type Pipe Insulation (Metal-Mesh Covered) (Industrial Type)

ASTM C665 - Standard Specification for Mineral-Fiber Blanket Thermal Insulation for Light Frame Construction and Manufactured Housing

ASTM C871 - Standard Test Methods for Chemical Analysis of Thermal Insulation Materials for Leachable Chloride, Fluoride, Silicate, and Sodium Ions

ASTM C892 - Standard Specification for High-Temperature Fiber Blanket Thermal Insulation

DELETED

ASTM E70 - Standard Test Method for pH of Aqueous Solutions with the Glass Electrode

(Copies of these documents are available online at www.astm.org.)

INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION FOR STANDARDIZATION (ISO)

ISO/IEC 17025 - General Requirements for the Competence of Testing and Calibration Laboratories

(Copies of this document are available online at www.iso.org.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.2.

3.2 Material. When specified (see 6.2), the thermal insulation blanket material shall be secured between metallic supporting members. The insulation material shall contain neither asbestos nor ceramic (refractory) fiber.

3.3 Physical requirements. The insulation material shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table I.

3.3.1 Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials. Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

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TABLE I. Physical requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Non-fibrous material (shot content), percent by weight, max.	20	4.5.1
Potential of hydrogen (pH)	<12	4.5.2
Corrosiveness to steel, copper, and aluminum	No corrosion greater than that observed with sterile cotton	4.5.3
Binder content, percent by weight, max.	1.5	4.5.4
Density, lb/ft^3 (without supporting metal facings)	8 - 12	4.5.5
Thermal conductivity, max. Btu in/hr sq. ft. degrees Fahrenheit at a mean temperature of		4.5.6
200 °F	0.31	
400 °F	0.44	
600 °F	0.60	
Moisture absorption, percent, max.	1.25	4.5.7

3.4 Dimensions. The length, width, and thickness of the insulation blanket shall be as specified (see 6.2). The tolerances shall be plus ¼ inch and minus ⅛ inch for thickness, ±½ inch for length, and ±¼ inch for width.

3.5 Supporting members. The supporting members shall consist of stainless steel metal-wire mesh on both sides of the insulations, metal-wire mesh on one side and metal lath on the other side, or without supporting members, as specified (see 6.2 and 6.9).

3.6 Resistance to vibration. The insulation blanket shall not, after heating/vibration, lose more than 15.0 percent in mass nor sag an average of more than 3 inches (see 4.5.8). There shall be no detrimental effect to the overall physical characteristics of the blanket when comparing to a control specimen. For example, bolts cutting through the insulation material, which cause large quantities of fiber or insulation blanket pieces to drop off the test stand holder during or after the test, is unacceptable.

3.7 Fire resistance. The insulation material without supporting members shall meet the requirements for insulating blankets in MIL-STD-1623 (see 4.5.9).

3.8 Maximum exothermic temperature rise. The insulation blanket mid-point temperature shall not exceed the hot surface temperature by more than 100 °F when tested in accordance with ASTM C411 and the hot surface performance section of ASTM C447 at the insulation's maximum use temperature and at the manufacturer's maximum recommended thickness for that temperature. The 100 °F criterion applies during heat up as well as steady state conditions (see 4.5.10).

3.9 Workmanship. The insulation blanket shall be free of defects such as jagged ends of metal-wire mesh, tie wire, or expanded metal; tie wires not properly spaced; tie wires not securely attached; metal-wire mesh not properly spaced; broken expanded metal; and supporting members not specified.

3.10 Toxicity. When evaluated in accordance with 4.5.11, the insulation blanket shall pose no serious or high risk to the health of personnel or the environment when used for its intended purpose (see 4.5.11 and 6.6).

3.11 Off-gassing. The insulation blanket shall be evaluated for off-gassing in accordance with the requirements of 4.5.12. Based on the circumstances of use and the chemical nature of the insulation blanket, the Navy will determine whether off-gas testing is required or if an administrative assessment is acceptable. In order to be considered acceptable for use in submarines, the insulation blanket shall be assigned to either the "Permitted" or "Limited" category (see 4.5.12 and 6.7).

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4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified herein. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.2).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.3).

4.2 First article inspection. First article inspection shall consist of the tests specified in table II (see 6.3). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), if more than one thickness of insulation blanket is acquired at any one time, only one blanket shall be tested to constitute the first article sample inspection.

TABLE II. First article inspection.

Inspection	Requirement	Test Method
Non-fibrous material (shot content)	3.3	4.5.1
pH	3.3	4.5.2
Corrosiveness to steel, copper, and aluminum	3.3	4.5.3
Binder content	3.3	4.5.4
Dimensions	3.4	4.5.5
Density	3.3	4.5.5
Thermal conductivity	3.3	4.5.6
Moisture absorption	3.3	4.5.7
Resistance to vibration	3.6	4.5.8
Fire resistance	3.7	4.5.9
Maximum exothermic temperature rise	3.8	4.5.10
Toxicity	3.10	4.5.11
Off-gassing[1/]	3.11	4.5.12

NOTE:
[1/] Shall be performed when specified (see 6.2).

4.3 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall be in accordance with table III and the examination of 4.4.

4.3.1 Exception. The thermal conductivity, resistance to vibration, fire resistance, and maximum exothermic temperature rise conformance tests only need to be conducted for one of the following reasons:

a. If within 1 year prior to the last test approval date the material has not been tested and found in compliance with section 3 and table I (as applicable), or

b. If the material being offered for delivery is not manufactured the same in all respects as that previously tested.

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TABLE III. Conformance inspection.

Inspection	Requirement	Test Method
Non-fibrous material (shot content)	3.3	4.5.1
Binder content	3.3	4.5.4
Dimensions	3.4	4.5.5
Density	3.3	4.5.5
Thermal conductivity[1/]	3.3	4.5.6
Resistance to vibration[1/]	3.6	4.5.8
Fire resistance	3.7	4.5.9
Maximum exothermic temperature rise[1/]	3.8	4.5.10
NOTE: [1/] Shall be performed when specified (see 6.2).		

4.3.2 Testing of the end item. When specified (see 6.2), conformance testing specified in 4.5 shall be conducted in accordance with table IV.

TABLE IV. Sampling for examination and test.

Lot Size	Sample Size
2 - 15	2
16 - 25	3
26 - 90	5
91 - 150	6
151 - 280	7
281 - 500	9
501 - 1,200	11
1,201- 3,200	13
3,201 - over	15
NOTE: 1. Rejected lots may be screened and resubmitted for inspection and test.	

4.4 Examination. When specified (see 6.2), blankets selected in accordance with the sampling guidance provided in 4.3.2 shall be surface examined (see 3.5 and 3.9) and measured (see 3.4) to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. Any blanket selected for examination that contains one or more visual or dimensional defects shall not be offered for delivery.

4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Non-fibrous material (shot content). The non-fibrous material (shot content) shall be tested as specified in ASTM C892.

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4.5.2 Potential of hydrogen (pH). Sample preparation shall be in accordance with ASTM C871. The pH shall be determined in accordance with the method specified in ASTM E70.

4.5.3 Corrosiveness to steel, copper, and aluminum. The insulation shall be tested in accordance with the corrosiveness method specified in ASTM C665.

4.5.4 Binder content. This test method determines the amount of organic binder present in the insulation. The percent binder by weight is measured by determining the weight lost by the insulation after placing it in a 1,000 °F furnace for 1 hour. The apparatus shall include a furnace capable of maintaining a 1,000 °F temperature and a scale accurate to 0.1 percent of the insulation sample's ("specimen") weight. Three test specimens shall be tested. Each test specimen shall weigh 75 to 150 grams. The specimens shall be weighed and then placed in the 1,000 °F furnace for 1 hour. The specimens shall then be removed from the furnace and cooled to room temperature in the same laboratory atmosphere (temperature and relative humidity) as they were before placing them in the furnace. When the specimens have cooled to ambient temperature, they shall be weighed. The percent binder for the three specimens is the average of the following calculation below:

$$B = \frac{Wi - Wf}{Wi} \times 100$$

Where:

B – Percent binder by weight

Wi – Initial weight

Wf – Final weight after 1 hour

4.5.5 Dimensions and density. The dimensions and density of the insulation shall be determined in accordance with the method specified in ASTM C167.

4.5.6 Thermal conductivity. Thermal conductivity shall be determined in accordance with the method specified in ASTM C177.

4.5.7 Moisture absorption. A 3½- by 3½- by 3-inch specimen of the insulation material component shall be weighed and then subjected to an atmosphere of 90±3 percent humidity at 120±3 °F for 6 hours. The specimen shall be weighed immediately upon removal from the test chamber and the percent moisture absorbed shall be determined.

4.5.8 Resistance to vibration. Vibration resistance shall be conducted in accordance with the test method in the Supplementary Requirements Section of ASTM C592.

4.5.9 Fire resistance. Fire resistance shall be conducted in accordance with the test method for insulating blankets in MIL-STD-1623.

4.5.10 Maximum exothermic temperature rise. The maximum exothermic temperature rise shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C411 and the hot surface performance section of ASTM C447 at the insulation's maximum use temperature and at the manufacturer's maximum recommended thickness for that temperature. The test surface shall be at the intended surface temperature when the test begins.

4.5.11 Toxicity. A Health Hazard Assessment (HHA) will be conducted to ensure conformance to 3.10 as specified (see 6.2). The Navy and Marine Corps Public Health Center (NMCPHC) will evaluate the insulation blanket using data provided by the manufacturer/distributor to the NMCPHC (see 3.10 and 6.6).

4.5.12 Off-gassing. The insulation blanket shall be evaluated for off-gassing in accordance with S9510-AB-ATM-010 chapter titled "Material Control Program" (see 3.11 and 6.7). If the Navy determines that off-gas testing is required, testing shall be conducted at a test facility approved by the Technical Authority (see 3.11 and 6.10). The Navy will review the off-gas test results and assign a usage category. Additionally, the Navy will assign a usage category if an administrative review is conducted in lieu of off-gas testing (see 3.11).

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4.5.13 Fire testing provisions. All fire tests specified in this document shall be conducted by an independent testing laboratory that is accredited to ISO/IEC 17025 and is acceptable to the Technical Authority. Accreditation shall be obtained from a recognized accreditation body such as the American Association for Laboratory Accreditation (A2LA) (www.A2LA.org) or the International Code Council's International Accreditation Services (IAS) (www.IASonline.org). The scope of accreditation shall include specific flammability and fire tests. All other fire test provisions shall be as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3.1).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The insulation blanket covered by this specification is intended for insulation of hot surfaces of machinery, boilers, and equipment at temperatures up to 1,200 °F.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. When a first article sample is required (see 3.1).

c. When material should be secured between metallic supporting members (see 3.2 and 3.5).

d. Length, width, and thickness required (see 3.4).

e. Whether metal-wire mesh on both sides, metal-wire mesh on one side and expanded metal lath on the other side, or no supporting members are required (see 3.5).

f. Requirements for an HHA (see 3.10 and 4.5.11).

g. Inspection conditions, if other than as specified (see 4.1 and 4.3.1).

h. First article inspection, if other than as specified (see 4.2).

i. Whether thermal conductivity, resistance to vibration, and maximum exothermic temperature rise tests should be performed (see tables II and III, as applicable).

j. Lot size, if other than as specified (see 4.3.2 and 4.4).

k. When conformance examination and testing are required (see 4.4 and 4.5).

l. Additional fire testing provisions (see 4.5.13 and 6.3.1).

m. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

n. Whether Material Safety Data Sheets are required (see 6.4).

6.3 Fire testing. Contractors are advised to review USCG 164.009 fire test requirements to determine whether their insulation product (manufactured in accordance with MIL-PRF-2818) automatically meets the criteria for non-combustibility without conducting prior fire tests, in which case only certification is required.

6.3.1 Additional fire testing provisions. The Technical Authority reserves the right to witness the tests and perform any of the tests set forth herein where such testing is deemed necessary to assure compliance to prescribed requirements. A2LA (www.A2LA.org) or International Code Council's IAS (www.IASonline.org) maintain a full list of the approved laboratories that are accredited to ISO/IEC 17025 and provide details on how to obtain and maintain accreditation (see 6.2).

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6.4 Material safety data sheets. When specified (see 6.2), contracting officers will identify those activities requiring copies of completed Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDSs) prepared in accordance with FED-STD-313. In order to obtain the MSDS, FAR clause 52.223-3 must be in the contract.

6.5 Lot acceptance and rejection criteria. If one or more defects are found in any sample (see 4.3.2), the entire lot should be rejected. The contractor has the option of screening 100 percent of the lot for the defective characteristic(s) or providing a new lot, which should be inspected in accordance with the sampling plan herein.

6.6 Toxicity evaluation. The NMCPHC requires sufficient information to permit an HHA of the product. Upon completion of the HHA, a copy will be provided by the NMCPHC to the Government for evaluation. The HHA process is described on the NMCPHC's website, https://www.med.navy.mil/Navy-Marine-Corps-Public-Health-Center/.

6.7 Material certification. Materials to be installed in submarines are to be controlled to prevent off-gassing, which contaminates the submarine's atmosphere and can result in health hazards to personnel or deleterious effects on machinery. These controls are administered through the Submarine Material Control Program, which is described in the Nuclear Powered Submarine Atmosphere Control Manual, S9510-AB-ATM-010 chapter titled "Material Control Program." Under the Submarine Material Control Program, all materials considered for use on submarines require certification and assignment of a usage category. Under the certification process, candidate materials are selected by Navy activities or contractors, and a request for certification is submitted to Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil. The certification request is accompanied by detailed information, including descriptions of the material, method of application, usage, and storage. A chemical analysis is conducted, which can be accomplished through off-gas testing. If off-gas testing is required, it must be conducted in a Government approved laboratory. Information pertaining to this test requirement may be obtained from Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil. Based on the chemical analysis results, a usage category is assigned to the material defining whether, and to what extent, the material may be used on submarines.

6.8 Certification. Consideration should be given to including certificates of compliance with each shipment of insulation. Certificates should indicate successful completion of the individual tests of conformance inspection.

6.9 Supporting members. Examples of supporting member configurations are as follows: 20-gauge, 1-inch 304 or 316 series stainless steel metal-wire mesh, approximately 1-inch hexagonal shaped on both sides of the insulation, or metal-wire mesh on one side and expanded metal lath (copper containing, not galvanized) having diamond shaped openings on the other side. When secured between supporting members, the supporting members are attached to each other by wires spaced 6¾ to 7¼ inches apart passing vertically through the blanket and should include rows within 2 inches from all edges of the blanket.

6.10 Technical Authority. The Technical Authority has the authority, responsibility, and accountability to establish, monitor, and approve technical standards, tools, and processes in conformance to higher authority policy, requirements, architectures, and standards. NAVSEA 05S may be contacted to determine the appropriate Technical Authority for any given requirement related to equipment and systems of U.S. Navy ships and submarines.

6.11 Subject term (key word) listing.

Insulation, boiler

Insulation, machinery

Metal mesh

Non-combustibility

Wire mesh

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6.12 Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army – CR4
Navy – SH

Preparing activity:
Navy – SH
(Project 5640-2021-004)

Review activity:
Navy – YD

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